NEW HOTEL OPENINGS

The hotel scene is hotting up with these key launches



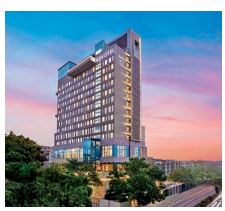
AMAN NAI LERT BANGKOK

Luxury leisure hotel chain Aman Resorts continues its foray into urban sanctuaries with Aman Nai Lert Bangkok, which opens on April 2. Located in the leafy embrace of the privately owned Nai Lert Park, it has 52 suites, among the largest in the city. There's a 1,500 square metre Aman Spa and an exclusive Aman Club. Symbolic of the origin of the hotel, a central feature is a majestic, 100-year-old Sompong tree. The hotel will provide signature experiences unveiling Bangkok's best-kept cultural and culinary secrets. Of course, in Aman style. (www.aman.com)



ANANTARA JEWEL BAGH JAIPUR

Anantara Hotels & Resorts finally makes its debut in India with the launch of Anantara Jewel Bagh Jaipur. The experiential luxury brand of Minor Hotels, Anantara brings its signature blend of authentic cultural experiences and world-class hospitality to the Pink City. Set amidst verdant landscapes and palatial architecture, this 150-key retreat serves as a tranquil gateway to Jaipur's rich heritage. (www.anantara.com)



NOVOTEL NEW DELHI CITY CENTRE

Set in Jhandewalan–and that's as central as it gets–the hotel offers access to key business hubs, shopping centres and cultural landmarks. The 124 thoughtfully designed guest rooms include an elegantly appointed Presidential Suite. The hotel's eco-conscious design aligns with Accor's global sustainability goals. (www.accor.com)

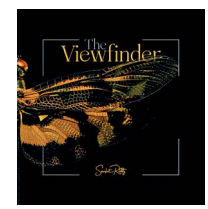






WHERE THE WILD THINGS ARE

The Viewfinder, wildlife photographer and nature enthusiast Sanket Reddy's debut coffee table book—which flaunts a foreword by actor R. Madhavan—is filled with jaw-dropping photographs. Sanket has shot wildlife all over the world, and it would be good to remember that this is a distillation of a huge and doubtless patient body of work. His India photographs are particularly impressive, given wildlife photography on Indian terrain can be challenging—as opposed to say the African savannah. These include images of the Star-Eyed Tree Frog, indigenous to the Western Ghats, the playful image of langurs and the classic red panda shot. Pithy descriptions of each species featured are accompanied by quirky quotes, which prevent the book from getting too academic. Like this one from the pit viper page: "Patience is a virtue that's greatly spoken by all,/ But rarely followed despite witnessing a million fall". Sanket's species approach to the project, with different ones on each spread, only works if the images are truly transfixing, which they are in this case.



The Viewfinder
By Sanket Reddy (Text and Photographs)
White Falcon Publishing
₹3,999

Compiled by Amit Dixit